Sources:



Figure 9.3 Sources of phosphorous

Foods rich in calcium are also rich in phosphorus. Animal sources include fish, meat, egg, milk, liver and kidneys. Plant sources of phosphorus are nuts, beans, green vegetables and fruits.

Absorption and Excretion:

Both calcium and phosphorus are absorbed from small intestine. Moderate amounts of fatty acid favor absorption of phosphorus. High calcium content in diet decreases the absorption of phosphorus.

Phosphates are mainly excreted by the kidneys as sodium dihydrogen phosphate through urine.

Deficiency:

Deficiency states for phosphorus are rare. Rickets, osteomalacia and osteoporosis are important dietary deficiency disorders of calcium and phosphorus. Low level of blood phosphorus is characterized by defective bone and teeth formation.

Unit 9.indd 233 21-05-2018 15:12:07